24 bài mẫu IELTS Writing Task 2 — Family & Society

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Opinion

#36 Opinion · 303 từ · AI 7.0

Discuss how technology affects relationships between people.

Smartphones, video calls and messaging apps have become part of nearly every friendship and family, and technology has changed how people relate to one another. This essay will explain two key ways in which technology affects relationships: by keeping people in touch across distance and by changing the quality of the time they spend together.

First and foremost, technology helps people to stay in touch and to form new connections. Video calls and messages connect families and friends across distances, and migrants and students abroad can speak to their relatives every day. A grandmother who watches her grandchildren's school play by video call from another country, for example, feels part of their lives. Social networks help people to find others who share their interests or circumstances, such as patients with a rare illness, and online communities can offer support to those who feel isolated in their own neighbourhood. Many friendships that would once have faded can now continue for years.

In addition, technology can weaken the quality of time together. Phones at the dinner table, constant notifications and the habit of checking messages reduce attention, so people may be in the same room without really listening to each other. Online communication can also be shallow, and conflicts can grow when tone is misunderstood in text. Online bullying and the pressure to display a perfect life on social media can harm self-esteem, especially among young people. However, these problems are not inevitable. Families can agree on phone-free meals, and friends can use messaging to arrange meetings in person. Relationships benefit when technology is used to add to face-to-face contact, not to replace it.

To sum up, technology affects relationships in both helpful and harmful ways, and its effect depends on how people choose to use it. For these reasons, it should be used thoughtfully.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Smartphones, video calls and messaging apps** — điện thoại thông minh, cuộc gọi video và ứng dụng nhắn tin
- **relate to one another** — quan hệ với nhau
- **technology affects relationships** — công nghệ ảnh hưởng quan hệ
- **across distance** — xuyên khoảng cách
- **the quality of the time they spend together** — chất lượng thời gian họ bên nhau
- **stay in touch** — giữ liên lạc
- **form new connections** — tạo kết nối mới
- **migrants and students abroad** — người di cư và sinh viên ở nước ngoài
- **feels part of their lives** — cảm thấy là một phần cuộc sống của chúng
- **share their interests or circumstances** — cùng sở thích hoặc hoàn cảnh
- **a rare illness** — một căn bệnh hiếm
- **isolated in their own neighbourhood** — cô lập ngay trong khu phố của mình
- **Phones at the dinner table** — điện thoại ở bàn ăn
- **constant notifications** — thông báo liên tục
- **without really listening to each other** — mà không thật sự lắng nghe nhau
- **tone is misunderstood in text** — giọng điệu bị hiểu sai trong văn bản
- **Online bullying** — bắt nạt trực tuyến
- **display a perfect life** — phô bày cuộc sống hoàn hảo
- **add to face-to-face contact, not to replace it** — bổ sung cho tiếp xúc trực tiếp chứ không thay thế

#123 Opinion · 305 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the role of parents in children's academic success.

When a child does well at school, parents often receive some of the credit, and when a child struggles, they sometimes receive the blame. This essay will explain two key ways in which parents influence children's academic success: through encouragement and routine, and through the resources and expectations that they provide.

First and foremost, parents shape children's academic success through encouragement, routine and interest. Children whose parents read with them, set regular times for homework and show curiosity about school tend to achieve more. A parent who sits with a child for twenty minutes of homework every evening, for example, shows that learning matters, and the child sees study as a normal part of life. Praise for effort rather than just results builds confidence and persistence, and a calm home with enough sleep and breakfast supports concentration. Talking to children about books, news and ideas also develops vocabulary and curiosity long before they start school.

In addition, parents provide resources and set expectations. They can buy books, find a quiet place to study, arrange tutors or help with school choices, and they communicate with teachers when problems arise. Realistic expectations motivate children, since young people often try to live up to what their parents believe they can do. However, excessive pressure can have the opposite effect, causing stress, anxiety and a dislike of learning. Parents are also not the only influence, as teachers, friends and the child's own character matter, and children from poorer families may succeed with the help of good schools and committed teachers. Support works better than pressure, and parents should show interest and encouragement rather than demanding top marks.

To sum up, parents play an important role in children's academic success by providing encouragement, structure and resources, provided that they avoid excessive pressure. For these reasons, their involvement should be welcomed.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **academic success** — thành công học tập
- **encouragement and routine** — sự động viên và nếp sinh hoạt
- **resources and expectations** — nguồn lực và kỳ vọng
- **encouragement, routine and interest** — động viên, nếp sinh hoạt và sự quan tâm
- **read with them** — đọc cùng chúng
- **set regular times for homework** — đặt giờ làm bài tập cố định
- **show curiosity about school** — tỏ ra tò mò về trường học
- **a normal part of life** — một phần bình thường của cuộc sống
- **Praise for effort rather than just results** — khen nỗ lực chứ không chỉ kết quả
- **builds confidence and persistence** — xây dựng sự tự tin và kiên trì
- **enough sleep and breakfast** — đủ giấc ngủ và bữa sáng
- **develops vocabulary and curiosity** — phát triển vốn từ và sự tò mò
- **find a quiet place to study** — tìm chỗ học yên tĩnh
- **arrange tutors** — sắp xếp gia sư
- **communicate with teachers** — trao đổi với giáo viên
- **live up to what their parents believe** — sống xứng với điều cha mẹ tin
- **excessive pressure** — áp lực quá mức
- **stress, anxiety and a dislike of learning** — căng thẳng, lo âu và ghét việc học
- **committed teachers** — giáo viên tận tâm
- **Support works better than pressure** — hỗ trợ hiệu quả hơn áp lực

#176 Opinion · 302 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss how volunteering abroad benefits communities and volunteers.

Every year, thousands of people spend weeks or months working without pay in distant countries, from building schools to teaching English, and the benefits of volunteering abroad are often discussed. This essay will explain two key ways in which volunteering abroad benefits communities and volunteers: by meeting real needs and by promoting learning and understanding.

First and foremost, volunteering abroad can help communities if it matches local needs. Volunteers with skills such as teaching or medicine fill real gaps and can bring knowledge, energy and extra hands to projects with limited funds. A volunteer who teaches English in a village for six months, for example, may help children to learn, but unless the project is planned, she may leave before it can continue. When projects are led by local people and organisations, the benefit lasts, because volunteers support community priorities rather than imposing their own. Volunteers can also raise funds and awareness back at home, bringing wider attention to local problems.

In addition, volunteers gain a great deal. They learn about other cultures and ways of life, develop language and practical skills, and often return with greater confidence, maturity and a wish to continue helping. Contact between people from different countries can reduce prejudice and build friendships across borders. However, there are risks. Short, poorly planned visits may take work from local people, create dependence or provide little real help, and volunteers without training can cause harm, for example in orphanages or clinics. Organisations should therefore select volunteers carefully, train them, work with local partners and measure results. Choosing reputable programmes is important for anyone who wants their time to make a difference.

To sum up, volunteering abroad benefits communities and volunteers when it meets local needs and is well organised. For these reasons, it deserves support, but only in responsible forms.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **working without pay in distant countries** — làm việc không lương ở nước xa
- **volunteering abroad** — tình nguyện ở nước ngoài
- **benefits communities and volunteers** — có lợi cho cộng đồng và tình nguyện viên
- **meeting real needs** — đáp ứng nhu cầu thực sự
- **promoting learning and understanding** — thúc đẩy học hỏi và thấu hiểu
- **matches local needs** — phù hợp nhu cầu địa phương
- **fill real gaps** — lấp khoảng trống thật
- **knowledge, energy and extra hands** — kiến thức, năng lượng và thêm nhân lực
- **limited funds** — nguồn lực hạn chế
- **teaches English in a village** — dạy tiếng Anh ở một ngôi làng
- **leave before it can continue** — rời đi trước khi dự án có thể tiếp tục
- **led by local people and organisations** — do người và tổ chức địa phương dẫn dắt
- **community priorities** — ưu tiên của cộng đồng
- **raise funds and awareness** — gây quỹ và nâng nhận thức
- **learn about other cultures** — tìm hiểu các nền văn hoá khác
- **develop language and practical skills** — phát triển ngôn ngữ và kỹ năng thực tế
- **greater confidence, maturity** — tự tin và chín chắn hơn
- **reduce prejudice** — giảm định kiến
- **build friendships across borders** — xây dựng tình bạn xuyên biên giới
- **take work from local people** — lấy việc của người địa phương
- **create dependence** — tạo ra sự phụ thuộc
- **reputable programmes** — chương trình uy tín
- **responsible** — có trách nhiệm

#196 Opinion · 302 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss how family traditions influence identity.

Every family has its own habits, from the way birthdays are celebrated to the stories told at dinner, and these shared customs shape how people see themselves. This essay will explain two key ways in which family traditions influence identity: by giving a sense of belonging and by passing on values and memories.

First and foremost, family traditions give children a sense of belonging and identity. Shared rituals such as festival meals, religious ceremonies and annual trips create a feeling of being part of a group with its own history. A family that cooks the same festival dish together every year, for example, creates memories that tie generations together. Children who take part know that they are connected to people before them and after them, which gives them security and a stable starting point from which to explore the world. Even simple customs, such as a weekly Sunday lunch, can make a child feel that he or she belongs.

In addition, traditions pass on values and cultural heritage. Through stories, songs and customs, grandparents and parents teach respect, generosity, honesty and the history of the family or community, often without formal lessons. Language, food and festivals link people to their culture, which matters particularly for families who have moved to another country. However, traditions can also restrict individual choice if they are applied rigidly, for example when young people feel pressured to follow a career or marriage that their family expects. Healthy traditions are flexible, allowing new generations to adapt them and to add their own. Identity then grows from a balance between inherited roots and personal choice.

To sum up, family traditions strongly influence identity by giving belonging and passing on values, provided that they allow room for individual development. For these reasons, they deserve to be valued and kept alive.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **shared customs** — phong tục chung
- **family traditions** — truyền thống gia đình
- **influence identity** — ảnh hưởng đến bản sắc
- **a sense of belonging** — cảm giác thuộc về
- **passing on values and memories** — truyền giá trị và ký ức
- **Shared rituals** — nghi thức chung
- **festival meals, religious ceremonies and annual trips** — bữa tiệc lễ, nghi lễ tôn giáo và chuyến đi hằng năm
- **part of a group with its own history** — một phần của nhóm có lịch sử riêng
- **cooks the same festival dish together** — cùng nấu một món lễ
- **tie generations together** — gắn kết các thế hệ
- **a stable starting point** — điểm xuất phát ổn định
- **a weekly Sunday lunch** — bữa trưa Chủ nhật hằng tuần
- **pass on values and cultural heritage** — truyền giá trị và di sản văn hoá
- **respect, generosity, honesty** — sự tôn trọng, hào phóng, trung thực
- **without formal lessons** — không cần bài học chính thức
- **link people to their culture** — nối con người với văn hoá của họ
- **restrict individual choice** — hạn chế lựa chọn cá nhân
- **applied rigidly** — áp dụng cứng nhắc
- **pressured to follow** — bị áp lực phải theo
- **inherited roots and personal choice** — cội nguồn thừa hưởng và lựa chọn cá nhân

#203 Opinion · 309 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the role of grandparents in child upbringing.

In many families, grandparents collect children from school, cook meals and tell stories, and they are an important part of how children grow up. This essay will explain two key roles that grandparents play in child upbringing: providing care and stability, and passing on values and a link with the past.

First and foremost, grandparents provide care, stability and emotional security. They look after grandchildren while parents work, which saves families money and gives working parents peace of mind. In some countries, grandparents provide a large share of childcare, and in households with a single parent or two jobs, their help can be essential. A grandparent in good health, for example, can help to look after grandchildren and pass on knowledge, which supports working parents. Children also gain from the patience and attention that grandparents often have time to give, and from having another adult who loves them unconditionally and who can be a refuge when there are tensions at home.

In addition, grandparents pass on values, stories and skills. A grandmother who tells stories about her childhood, for example, gives a child a living link with history, and grandparents often teach traditions, language, cooking, crafts and manners. This helps children to understand their roots and to respect older people. However, there are some difficulties. Grandparents may have different ideas about discipline, sweets or screen time, which can cause conflict with parents, and their own health or energy may limit what they can do. Clear communication between generations, and respect for the parents' final say, usually resolve such disagreements. Where possible, children should also be encouraged to contribute to the relationship, for instance by helping grandparents with technology.

To sum up, grandparents play a valuable role in child upbringing by providing care and by passing on values and heritage. For these reasons, their contribution should be recognised and supported.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **collect children from school** — đón trẻ từ trường
- **child upbringing** — nuôi dạy trẻ
- **care and stability** — chăm sóc và sự ổn định
- **passing on values and a link with the past** — truyền giá trị và nối với quá khứ
- **care, stability and emotional security** — sự chăm sóc, ổn định và an toàn cảm xúc
- **look after grandchildren while parents work** — chăm cháu khi cha mẹ đi làm
- **peace of mind** — sự yên tâm
- **a large share of childcare** — phần lớn việc chăm trẻ
- **pass on knowledge** — truyền lại kinh nghiệm
- **supports working parents** — hỗ trợ bố mẹ đi làm
- **the patience and attention** — sự kiên nhẫn và chú ý
- **loves them unconditionally** — yêu thương chúng vô điều kiện
- **a refuge when there are tensions at home** — nơi nương tựa khi ở nhà căng thẳng
- **a living link with history** — mối liên kết sống động với lịch sử
- **traditions, language, cooking, crafts and manners** — truyền thống, ngôn ngữ, nấu ăn, thủ công và cách cư xử
- **understand their roots** — hiểu cội nguồn của mình
- **respect older people** — tôn trọng người lớn tuổi
- **different ideas about discipline** — quan điểm khác về kỷ luật
- **cause conflict with parents** — gây xung đột với cha mẹ
- **respect for the parents' final say** — tôn trọng quyền quyết định cuối cùng của cha mẹ

#256 Opinion · 301 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss how family meals affect children's development.

In many homes, the evening meal is one of the few occasions when the whole family is together, though it is becoming less common as schedules grow busier. This essay will explain two key ways in which family meals affect children's development: through health and nutrition, and through communication and emotional security.

First and foremost, regular family meals support children's health and eating habits. Children who eat with their parents tend to eat more vegetables and less junk food, and they learn table manners, portion control and the idea that food is something to share. A child who talks about his day at the dinner table, for example, practises telling a story and feels that his parents are interested. Research has linked frequent family meals with lower rates of obesity and eating disorders, and with better school results, although part of this may reflect other advantages of families who manage to eat together. Parents also have a chance to notice if a child is eating too little or too much.

In addition, family meals support communication and emotional security. Conversation builds vocabulary, listening skills and confidence, and children feel that their lives matter to others. Regular time together gives parents opportunities to learn about friends, problems and worries before they become serious, and children who feel connected are less likely to take risks such as substance abuse. However, busy schedules and long working hours make the habit harder, and meals are only valuable if they are relaxed. Arguments, strict control or phones at the table can spoil the benefits. Even a few shared meals a week, with screens switched off, bring real advantages.

To sum up, family meals promote children's development by supporting healthy eating and by strengthening communication and security. For these reasons, families should try to protect this time.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **the evening meal** — bữa tối
- **the whole family is together** — cả gia đình ở bên nhau
- **family meals** — bữa ăn gia đình
- **children's development** — sự phát triển của trẻ
- **health and nutrition** — sức khoẻ và dinh dưỡng
- **communication and emotional security** — giao tiếp và an toàn cảm xúc
- **support children's health and eating habits** — hỗ trợ sức khoẻ và thói quen ăn uống của trẻ
- **more vegetables and less junk food** — nhiều rau hơn và ít đồ ăn vặt hơn
- **table manners, portion control** — phép lịch sự bàn ăn, kiểm soát khẩu phần
- **something to share** — điều để chia sẻ
- **talks about his day** — kể về ngày của mình
- **practises telling a story** — luyện tập kể chuyện
- **lower rates of obesity and eating disorders** — tỷ lệ béo phì và rối loạn ăn uống thấp hơn
- **notice if a child is eating too little or too much** — nhận ra trẻ ăn quá ít hay quá nhiều
- **builds vocabulary, listening skills and confidence** — xây vốn từ, kỹ năng nghe và sự tự tin
- **their lives matter to others** — cuộc sống của chúng quan trọng với người khác
- **before they become serious** — trước khi chúng trở nên nghiêm trọng
- **take risks such as substance abuse** — liều lĩnh như lạm dụng chất
- **screens switched off** — tắt màn hình
- **healthy eating** — ăn uống lành mạnh

#438 Opinion · 318 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss how family leave policies affect gender equality.

In most countries, women still take more time off than men after a child is born, and this difference affects careers, pay and attitudes. This essay will explain two key ways in which family leave policies affect gender equality: by influencing who cares for children and by changing how employers and society treat men and women.

First and foremost, paid leave for both parents helps to share care and reduces career penalties for women. When only mothers take leave, employers may see women as less committed, whereas fathers who take time off become more involved at home and make childcare normal for both sexes. A father who takes three months of paid leave, for example, learns to care for a baby on his own and shares the load with his partner afterwards. Research in Nordic countries suggests that earmarked leave for fathers, which is lost if not used, increases the share of care that fathers provide, and this leads to more equal division of housework in later years. Women can then return to work sooner and keep their careers moving.

In addition, leave policies shape attitudes and employer behaviour. If both sexes are expected to take leave, employers can no longer assume that only women will be absent, which reduces discrimination in hiring and promotion, and children grow up seeing both parents as carers. However, equality improves only when leave is well paid and fathers are encouraged to use it. Low pay discourages fathers from taking leave, long leave for mothers alone can make women's absence from work longer, and some workplaces still look down on men who ask for time off. Generous, flexible and shared leave, supported by campaigns, is therefore most effective.

To sum up, family leave policies can improve gender equality when they support shared care and change workplace attitudes. For these reasons, they should be designed with fathers as well as mothers in mind.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **women still take more time off than men** — phụ nữ vẫn nghỉ nhiều hơn nam
- **a child is born** — đứa trẻ chào đời
- **family leave policies** — chính sách nghỉ chăm con
- **gender equality** — bình đẳng giới
- **influencing who cares for children** — ảnh hưởng ai chăm sóc trẻ
- **changing how employers and society treat men and women** — thay đổi cách nhà tuyển dụng và xã hội đối xử với nam và nữ
- **paid leave for both parents** — nghỉ có lương cho cả hai bậc cha mẹ
- **share care** — chia sẻ việc chăm sóc
- **career penalties for women** — bất lợi nghề nghiệp đối với phụ nữ
- **less committed** — kém cam kết hơn
- **become more involved at home** — tham gia nhiều hơn ở nhà
- **make childcare normal for both sexes** — làm việc chăm con thành bình thường cho cả hai giới
- **three months of paid leave** — ba tháng nghỉ có lương
- **earmarked leave for fathers** — kỳ nghỉ dành riêng cho cha
- **more equal division of housework** — phân chia việc nhà đều hơn
- **return to work** — trở lại làm việc
- **keep their careers moving** — giữ sự nghiệp tiếp tục
- **discrimination in hiring and promotion** — phân biệt đối xử khi tuyển dụng và thăng tiến
- **look down on men who ask for time off** — coi thường đàn ông xin nghỉ
- **generous, flexible and shared leave** — nghỉ hào phóng, linh hoạt và chia sẻ

Discuss both views

#45 Discuss both views · 276 từ · AI 8.0

Some people believe that volunteering benefits society. Others think it primarily benefits volunteers. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Hospitals, schools and charities rely on people who give their time without payment, and opinions differ on whether volunteering mainly benefits society or primarily benefits the volunteers. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters argue that volunteering benefits society. Volunteers provide help that public services cannot always afford, from tutoring to care for older people, and many charities could not survive without them. A retired teacher who helps children to read after school, for example, offers support that the school could not pay for. Volunteering also builds community, since people who work together on a common cause meet neighbours they would not otherwise know and develop trust. In emergencies, from floods to pandemics, volunteers have often made the difference between a coordinated response and chaos. The work also shows that people care about each other beyond family ties.

On the other hand, others point out that volunteers themselves gain a great deal. They learn skills such as organising, communicating and teamwork, which may help them to find paid work, and they gain friendships, confidence and a sense of purpose. For young people, volunteering can provide experience that improves a career application, and for retired people it can reduce loneliness. A retired teacher who helps children to read, for instance, finds new purpose herself. Some critics suggest that this self-interest means volunteering is not truly selfless, although such motives do not reduce the value of the help given.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that volunteering benefits both society and the volunteer, and that this mutual benefit is the reason why it works so well.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **give their time without payment** — dành thời gian không lấy tiền
- **benefits society** — có lợi cho xã hội
- **primarily benefits the volunteers** — chủ yếu có lợi cho người tình nguyện
- **volunteering benefits society** — tình nguyện có lợi cho xã hội
- **help that public services cannot always afford** — sự giúp đỡ mà dịch vụ công không phải lúc nào cũng đủ tiền cung cấp
- **tutoring to care for older people** — kèm cặp đến chăm sóc người già
- **could not survive without them** — không thể tồn tại nếu thiếu họ
- **a retired teacher** — một giáo viên về hưu
- **builds community** — xây dựng cộng đồng
- **a common cause** — một mục tiêu chung
- **develop trust** — phát triển lòng tin
- **a coordinated response and chaos** — phản ứng có phối hợp và hỗn loạn
- **care about each other beyond family ties** — quan tâm lẫn nhau vượt ngoài quan hệ gia đình
- **learn skills such as organising, communicating and teamwork** — học kỹ năng như tổ chức, giao tiếp và làm việc nhóm
- **find paid work** — tìm việc có lương
- **friendships, confidence and a sense of purpose** — tình bạn, sự tự tin và cảm giác có mục đích
- **improves a career application** — cải thiện hồ sơ xin việc
- **reduce loneliness** — giảm cô đơn
- **not truly selfless** — không hoàn toàn vị tha
- **mutual benefit** — lợi ích hỗ tương

#111 Discuss both views · 290 từ · AI 7.5

Is it better to focus government spending on childcare or on elder care? Discuss and give your opinion.

Many countries face two demographic pressures at once: young families need help to raise children, while the number of very old people is growing quickly. This is why opinions are divided as to whether public money should be focused on childcare or on elder care. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of childcare argue that it invests in the future and lets parents work. Good care in the early years builds language, social skills and curiosity, helping children to do well at school and later in life. A child who spends mornings in a good nursery, for example, enters school already able to listen, share and speak in sentences. When affordable care is available, parents, especially mothers, can return to work, which raises household income and tax revenue. The returns on early investment are large, since healthier, better-educated children become productive adults who will support future generations.

On the other hand, supporters of elder care point out that older people have often worked and paid taxes for decades and deserve dignity in their final years. Many suffer from frailty, dementia or loneliness, and without care they may be neglected, while their relatives are forced to cut their working hours. A woman who looks after both her young children and her elderly mother, for example, may be forced to give up her job. With populations ageing, the demand for care is growing fast, and failure to meet it would cause great suffering.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that a balanced budget is wise, with childcare given priority where early investment is most lacking, while elder care is expanded in line with the growth of the ageing population.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **demographic pressures** — áp lực nhân khẩu học
- **raise children** — nuôi con
- **very old people** — người rất già
- **public money** — tiền công
- **invests in the future** — đầu tư vào tương lai
- **lets parents work** — giúp cha mẹ có thể làm việc
- **curiosity** — sự tò mò
- **do well at school and later in life** — học tốt ở trường và về sau trong cuộc đời
- **listen, share and speak in sentences** — lắng nghe, chia sẻ và nói thành câu
- **return to work** — trở lại làm việc
- **raises household income and tax revenue** — tăng thu nhập hộ gia đình và nguồn thu thuế
- **The returns on early investment are large** — lợi ích từ đầu tư sớm là lớn
- **productive adults** — người trưởng thành năng suất
- **support future generations** — hỗ trợ các thế hệ sau
- **worked and paid taxes for decades** — làm việc và đóng thuế hàng chục năm
- **dignity in their final years** — phẩm giá trong những năm cuối đời
- **frailty, dementia or loneliness** — yếu đuối, sa sút trí tuệ hoặc cô đơn
- **neglected** — bị bỏ rơi
- **forced to cut their working hours** — bị buộc giảm giờ làm
- **give up her job** — bỏ việc
- **the demand for care is growing fast** — nhu cầu chăm sóc tăng nhanh
- **great suffering** — đau khổ lớn
- **a balanced budget is wise** — ngân sách cân bằng là khôn ngoan
- **the growth of the ageing population** — sự gia tăng của dân số già

#192 Discuss both views · 292 từ · AI 8.0

Should individuals be responsible for volunteering, or should society/government encourage it? Discuss.

Charities, schools and neighbourhood groups depend on people who give their time freely, and opinions differ on whether individuals should be responsible for volunteering or whether society and government should encourage it. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of personal responsibility argue that volunteering depends on personal motivation. People volunteer when they care about a cause, and a gift of time is valuable precisely because it is freely given. Forcing or pressuring people may produce half-hearted effort and resentment, and a person who is made to volunteer may not value the work. A resident who chooses to help clean a river because she loves the place, for example, is likely to work harder and keep going longer than someone who is told to do so. Voluntary service also reflects a healthy civil society in which citizens, not officials, take the initiative to solve problems.

On the other hand, supporters of public encouragement point out that many people would volunteer if it were made easier. Schools can offer course credit for community service, employers can provide paid time off, and governments can fund volunteer organisations, provide training and recognise the work with awards or tax benefits. Many people do not volunteer simply because they do not know how to start or cannot spare the time. Such support does not remove the voluntary element, but it opens opportunities, especially for young people and those from poorer backgrounds who might not otherwise get involved. Well-run organisations also ensure that volunteers' time is used effectively.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that volunteering should remain a personal choice, but governments, schools and employers should make it easier and more rewarding through practical support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **give their time freely** — dành thời gian một cách tự nguyện
- **responsible for volunteering** — chịu trách nhiệm về tình nguyện
- **society and government should encourage it** — xã hội và chính phủ nên khuyến khích nó
- **supporters of personal responsibility** — người ủng hộ trách nhiệm cá nhân
- **depends on personal motivation** — phụ thuộc vào động cơ cá nhân
- **a gift of time** — món quà thời gian
- **freely given** — được cho một cách tự nguyện
- **half-hearted effort and resentment** — nỗ lực nửa vời và sự bực bội
- **made to volunteer** — bị buộc phải tình nguyện
- **a healthy civil society** — một xã hội dân sự lành mạnh
- **take the initiative** — chủ động
- **solve problems** — giải quyết vấn đề
- **made easier** — được làm dễ dàng hơn
- **course credit for community service** — điểm quá trình cho hoạt động cộng đồng
- **paid time off** — nghỉ phép có lương
- **fund volunteer organisations** — tài trợ cho các tổ chức tình nguyện
- **recognise the work with awards or tax benefits** — ghi nhận công việc bằng giải thưởng hoặc ưu đãi thuế
- **cannot spare the time** — không thể dành thời gian
- **voluntary element** — yếu tố tự nguyện
- **opens opportunities** — mở ra cơ hội
- **a personal choice** — một lựa chọn cá nhân

#245 Discuss both views · 269 từ · AI 8.0

Some people believe that online dating benefits modern relationships. Others disagree. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Millions of people now look for partners through websites and apps, and some believe that online dating benefits modern relationships. Others disagree. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters argue that online dating widens choice and makes it easier to meet compatible people. People can meet far more potential partners than in their daily circle, filter by interests and values, and begin conversations at their own pace, which helps the shy and busy. A shy engineer who rarely meets new people at work, for example, may find a partner through an app that matches shared interests. Online dating can also help people who live in small communities, who have recently moved or who belong to minority groups with few partners nearby. Many successful couples now meet online, and the stigma that once surrounded the practice has largely disappeared.

On the other hand, critics argue that online dating can encourage deception and shallow judgements. Profiles can be exaggerated or false, people are judged quickly by photos, and an endless supply of choices may reduce commitment, as users keep looking for someone slightly better. Some users face scams, harassment or safety risks when meeting strangers. Constant rejection can also damage self-esteem. Relationships formed through screens may rely too heavily on appearance, and the pressure of presenting an ideal image can make people less honest.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that online dating can benefit modern relationships by widening opportunities, provided that users are honest, take safety precautions such as meeting in public places, and treat others with respect.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **look for partners through websites and apps** — tìm bạn đời qua website và ứng dụng
- **online dating** — hẹn hò trực tuyến
- **benefits modern relationships** — có lợi cho các mối quan hệ hiện đại
- **widens choice** — mở rộng lựa chọn
- **compatible people** — những người hợp nhau
- **potential partners** — bạn đời tiềm năng
- **filter by interests and values** — lọc theo sở thích và giá trị
- **begin conversations at their own pace** — bắt đầu trò chuyện theo nhịp độ của mình
- **the shy and busy** — người nhút nhát và bận rộn
- **matches shared interests** — ghép theo sở thích chung
- **small communities** — cộng đồng nhỏ
- **minority groups** — nhóm thiểu số
- **deception and shallow judgements** — lừa dối và đánh giá hời hợt
- **exaggerated or false** — bị phóng đại hoặc giả
- **judged quickly by photos** — bị đánh giá nhanh qua ảnh
- **an endless supply of choices** — nguồn lựa chọn vô tận
- **reduce commitment** — giảm sự cam kết
- **scams, harassment or safety risks** — lừa đảo, quấy rối hoặc rủi ro an toàn
- **damage self-esteem** — làm hại lòng tự trọng
- **meeting in public places** — gặp ở nơi công cộng

#360 Discuss both views · 281 từ · AI 7.5

Some people prefer to raise children with strict rules while others prefer permissive parenting. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Parents everywhere ask how firmly they should control their children, and opinions are divided as to whether children should be raised with strict rules or with a more permissive approach. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of strict parenting argue that clear rules give children structure, safety and self-discipline. When expectations and consequences are consistent, children know what to expect, learn to control impulses and are protected from risks. A teenager with a clear curfew, for example, knows what is expected and is less likely to stay out in unsafe places. Children who grow up with firm boundaries often do well at school because they learn to concentrate, finish tasks and respect authority. They may also feel more secure, since they know that adults are in charge. Supporters believe that too much freedom early in life can lead to selfishness and difficulty with rules at school or work.

On the other hand, supporters of permissive parenting argue that a relaxed style encourages independence, creativity and close relationships. Children who are given freedom to make choices and are listened to tend to be confident and open with their parents, and they learn from the consequences of their own decisions. Harsh rules, in contrast, can cause fear, secrecy and rebellion, and children may behave well only when watched. Warm and flexible parents build trust, which makes children more likely to seek advice. However, without boundaries children may struggle with self-control and respect for others.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that the best approach combines warmth with clear limits: rules should be explained, applied fairly and relaxed as children mature.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **raised with strict rules** — được nuôi với quy tắc nghiêm ngặt
- **a more permissive approach** — cách tiếp cận dễ dãi hơn
- **supporters of strict parenting** — người ủng hộ nuôi dạy nghiêm khắc
- **structure, safety and self-discipline** — cấu trúc, an toàn và tính tự giác
- **expectations and consequences are consistent** — kỳ vọng và hệ quả nhất quán
- **learn to control impulses** — học kiểm soát xung động
- **protected from risks** — được bảo vệ khỏi rủi ro
- **a clear curfew** — giờ giới nghiêm rõ ràng
- **firm boundaries** — ranh giới vững chắc
- **respect authority** — tôn trọng thẩm quyền
- **adults are in charge** — người lớn nắm quyền
- **too much freedom early in life** — quá nhiều tự do từ sớm
- **encourages independence, creativity and close relationships** — khuyến khích độc lập, sáng tạo và quan hệ gần gũi
- **given freedom to make choices** — được tự do lựa chọn
- **learn from the consequences of their own decisions** — học từ hệ quả quyết định của chính mình
- **fear, secrecy and rebellion** — sợ hãi, giấu giếm và nổi loạn
- **behave well only when watched** — chỉ ngoan khi bị theo dõi
- **warm and flexible parents** — cha mẹ ấm áp và linh hoạt
- **self-control and respect for others** — tự chủ và tôn trọng người khác
- **warmth with clear limits** — sự ấm áp kèm giới hạn rõ ràng

#487 Discuss both views · 300 từ · AI 7.0

Should individuals be responsible for preventing child labour, or should society/government take action? Discuss.

Millions of children around the world work in farms, mines, factories and homes instead of going to school, and opinions differ on whether individuals should be responsible for preventing child labour or whether society and government should take action. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of individual responsibility argue that ordinary people can contribute. Consumers can choose products that are certified as free from child labour and avoid brands that have been linked to it, which gives companies a commercial reason to check their suppliers. Parents can send their children to school instead of work, and people who see children working illegally can report it. A shopper who refuses to buy goods that are suspiciously cheap, for example, sends a message to manufacturers. Public pressure from consumers and campaigns has in the past persuaded several major companies to change their supply chains. Employers, too, bear responsibility for ensuring that no children work in their businesses.

On the other hand, advocates of government and society action point out that child labour is mainly caused by poverty and can only be ended by action at several levels. Families that need income send children to work, consumers cannot always see how goods are made, and only governments can pass laws, inspect workplaces and provide schools and support for poor families. A ten-year-old who works in a brick factory to help his family, for example, misses school and may never escape poverty. Governments can also make companies publish information about their supply chains and punish those who break the law. International cooperation is needed because goods cross borders.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that governments and companies must take the main responsibility, with consumers and parents playing a supporting role.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Millions of children around the world work** — hàng triệu trẻ em trên thế giới đi làm
- **farms, mines, factories and homes** — nông trại, mỏ, nhà máy và gia đình
- **instead of going to school** — thay vì đi học
- **responsible** — có trách nhiệm
- **preventing child labour** — ngăn chặn lao động trẻ em
- **supporters of individual responsibility** — người ủng hộ trách nhiệm cá nhân
- **certified as free from child labour** — được chứng nhận không có lao động trẻ em
- **a commercial reason to check their suppliers** — lý do thương mại để kiểm tra nhà cung cấp
- **suspiciously cheap** — rẻ một cách đáng ngờ
- **sends a message to manufacturers** — gửi thông điệp cho nhà sản xuất
- **public pressure from consumers** — áp lực công chúng từ người tiêu dùng
- **change their supply chains** — thay đổi chuỗi cung ứng
- **bear responsibility** — chịu trách nhiệm
- **child labour** — lao động trẻ em
- **mainly caused by poverty** — chủ yếu do nghèo đói
- **action at several levels** — hành động ở nhiều cấp
- **Families that need income** — gia đình cần thu nhập
- **pass laws** — ban hành luật
- **inspect workplaces** — thanh tra nơi làm việc
- **a brick factory** — một lò gạch
- **misses school** — bỏ lỡ việc học
- **publish information about their supply chains** — công bố thông tin về chuỗi cung ứng của họ
- **International cooperation** — hợp tác quốc tế

#488 Discuss both views · 290 từ · AI 8.0

Should individuals be responsible for ensuring equal opportunities, or should society/government take action? Discuss.

Most people agree that everyone should have a fair chance in life, whatever their background, but opinions differ on whether individuals should be responsible for ensuring equal opportunities or whether society and government should take action. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of individual responsibility argue that fair treatment begins with personal attitudes and choices. Employers decide whom to hire and promote, teachers decide how to treat pupils, and neighbours decide whether to welcome newcomers, so prejudice can be reduced only if individuals choose to judge others on merit. A manager who gives a fair chance to every applicant, for example, widens opportunities for people who might otherwise be overlooked. Individuals can also challenge discriminatory remarks and behaviour in their daily lives, and those who succeed can mentor others. Legal rules cannot succeed unless people accept the principle of fairness.

On the other hand, advocates of government and societal action point out that discrimination is often hidden and structural. Equal opportunity needs fair attitudes from individuals and strong rules and support from government. Only laws, public education and help for disadvantaged groups can change patterns that no single person controls, such as unequal school funding, differences in housing and bias in recruitment systems. A company that removes names and photographs from applications, for example, can reduce bias at the first stage of hiring, and governments can require such practices. Scholarships, free early education and anti-discrimination laws help to give people from poorer or minority backgrounds a real chance.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that governments must take the lead by setting rules and providing support, while individuals make equality real through fair behaviour in daily life.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a fair chance in life** — cơ hội công bằng trong cuộc sống
- **whatever their background** — bất kể xuất thân
- **responsible** — có trách nhiệm
- **equal opportunities** — cơ hội bình đẳng
- **supporters of individual responsibility** — người ủng hộ trách nhiệm cá nhân
- **fair treatment begins with personal attitudes and choices** — đối xử công bằng bắt đầu từ thái độ và lựa chọn cá nhân
- **decide whom to hire and promote** — quyết định thuê và thăng chức ai
- **welcome newcomers** — chào đón người mới
- **judge others on merit** — đánh giá người khác theo năng lực
- **a fair chance to every applicant** — cơ hội công bằng cho mọi ứng viên
- **overlooked** — bị bỏ qua
- **challenge discriminatory remarks and behaviour** — thách thức lời nói và hành vi phân biệt đối xử
- **mentor others** — làm cố vấn cho người khác
- **hidden and structural** — ẩn và mang tính cấu trúc
- **Only laws, public education and help for disadvantaged groups** — chỉ luật pháp, giáo dục công và hỗ trợ nhóm thiệt thòi
- **patterns that no single person controls** — những quy luật không ai riêng lẻ kiểm soát
- **unequal school funding** — tài trợ trường học không đồng đều
- **bias in recruitment systems** — thiên vị trong hệ thống tuyển dụng
- **removes names and photographs from applications** — bỏ tên và ảnh khỏi hồ sơ xin việc
- **reduce bias at the first stage of hiring** — giảm thiên vị ở giai đoạn đầu tuyển dụng
- **anti-discrimination laws** — luật chống phân biệt đối xử
- **a real chance** — cơ hội thực sự
- **take the lead** — đi đầu

Agree / Disagree

#81 Agree / Disagree · 297 từ · AI 7.0

Some people say that pets are as important as family members. Do you agree or disagree?

Many owners treat their dogs and cats as part of the household, and some people say that pets are as important as family members. I disagree with this view, since pets give companionship and joy but cannot replace human family members, although their value should not be dismissed.

To begin with, pets give companionship and joy but cannot replace human family members. They reduce loneliness and encourage exercise and responsibility, yet they cannot offer the shared history, conversation and mutual obligations that bind a family. A widow whose dog greets her every day, for example, feels less alone, but the dog cannot replace the conversation of a relative or understand her worries. Family members support one another through illness, financial difficulty and important decisions, and they share memories that stretch over generations. A pet, however loved, does not take part in these exchanges in the same way. Humans also have rights and a moral status that animals, though deserving of kindness, do not share to the same degree.

Furthermore, treating pets as equal to relatives can lead to difficult choices. If a family's time and money are spent on pets at the expense of children or elderly parents, it may cause resentment, and decisions about medical care or inheritance become confusing. Admittedly, pets are important to many people, especially those who live alone, and the grief at losing one can be genuine and deep. Some therapy animals even help to treat anxiety and loneliness. This importance deserves respect, but it differs in kind from the relationships between people. A balanced view recognises pets as valued companions and family members as irreplaceable.

In conclusion, I disagree that pets are as important as family members, because they cannot offer the same relationships or obligations, although they enrich many lives.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **treat their dogs and cats as part of the household** — coi chó mèo như một phần gia đình
- **as important as family members** — quan trọng như thành viên gia đình
- **companionship and joy** — bầu bạn và niềm vui
- **cannot replace human family members** — không thể thay thế thành viên gia đình là con người
- **reduce loneliness** — giảm cô đơn
- **encourage exercise and responsibility** — khuyến khích vận động và tinh thần trách nhiệm
- **shared history, conversation and mutual obligations** — lịch sử chung, đối thoại và nghĩa vụ hỗ tương
- **bind a family** — gắn kết một gia đình
- **a widow** — người goá phụ
- **greets her every day** — chào đón cô mỗi ngày
- **understand her worries** — hiểu những lo lắng của cô
- **support one another through illness** — nâng đỡ nhau qua bệnh tật
- **memories that stretch over generations** — ký ức kéo dài qua nhiều thế hệ
- **a moral status** — địa vị đạo đức
- **deserving of kindness** — đáng được đối xử tử tế
- **at the expense of children or elderly parents** — gây thiệt cho con cái hoặc cha mẹ già
- **resentment** — sự bực bội
- **grief at losing one** — nỗi đau khi mất đi một con
- **therapy animals** — động vật trị liệu
- **irreplaceable** — không thể thay thế

#146 Agree / Disagree · 298 từ · AI 8.0

To what extent do you agree or disagree that children should not use smartphones?

Many children now receive a smartphone before they start secondary school, and some argue that children should not use smartphones at all. I agree to a large extent, since young children are not ready for unrestricted phones, although complete bans are neither realistic nor always desirable for older children.

To begin with, young children are not ready for unrestricted smartphones. Phones distract from schoolwork, disturb sleep, expose children to unsuitable content and online bullying, and replace play and exercise, although they allow parents and children to stay in contact. A ten-year-old who scrolls on a phone in bed until midnight, for example, arrives at school tired and distracted. Studies have linked heavy use among young people to anxiety, low mood and poor sleep, and games and social media are designed to hold attention for as long as possible. Children also lack the judgment to deal with strangers, advertising and pressure to share personal images, and they may not tell adults when something goes wrong.

Furthermore, childhood is a time for activities that phones can replace, such as outdoor play, reading, face-to-face friendship and hobbies. Delaying and limiting use protects health, learning and development. However, a complete ban has drawbacks. Phones can keep children safe by allowing them to call parents, and as they grow older they need to learn how to use technology responsibly, since it is part of modern life. A sensible approach would give young children a basic phone, if any, set clear rules about when and where phones are used, and allow smartphones gradually, with parental controls and conversations about safety, from around the early teens.

In conclusion, children should not use smartphones freely, particularly when young, because of the risks to health and learning, but supervised and limited use as they mature is reasonable.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **receive a smartphone before they start secondary school** — nhận điện thoại thông minh trước khi vào cấp hai
- **children should not use smartphones** — trẻ em không nên dùng điện thoại thông minh
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **not ready for unrestricted phones** — chưa sẵn sàng cho điện thoại không hạn chế
- **distract from schoolwork** — làm xao nhãng bài vở
- **disturb sleep** — làm rối loạn giấc ngủ
- **unsuitable content and online bullying** — nội dung không phù hợp và bắt nạt trực tuyến
- **replace play and exercise** — thay thế vui chơi và vận động
- **stay in contact** — giữ liên lạc
- **scrolls on a phone in bed** — lướt điện thoại trên giường
- **tired and distracted** — mệt mỏi và xao nhãng
- **heavy use among young people** — dùng nhiều ở người trẻ
- **anxiety, low mood and poor sleep** — lo âu, tâm trạng thấp và ngủ kém
- **designed to hold attention** — được thiết kế để giữ sự chú ý
- **lack the judgment** — thiếu khả năng phán đoán
- **pressure to share personal images** — áp lực chia sẻ hình ảnh cá nhân
- **outdoor play, reading, face-to-face friendship** — chơi ngoài trời, đọc sách, tình bạn trực tiếp
- **a complete ban** — lệnh cấm hoàn toàn
- **use technology responsibly** — dùng công nghệ có trách nhiệm
- **parental controls** — kiểm soát của cha mẹ
- **supervised and limited use** — dùng có giám sát và có giới hạn

#369 Agree / Disagree · 292 từ · AI 7.5

Many people say that community festivals strengthen social bonds. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

From street parties to harvest fairs and religious celebrations, communities around the world mark special days together, and many people say that community festivals strengthen social bonds. I agree with this view, since festivals bring neighbours together and create shared memories, although they work best when everyone can take part.

To begin with, community festivals bring neighbours together and create shared memories. People who might not normally meet cook, perform and celebrate side by side, which builds trust, pride in the place and a sense of belonging. A street party where every household brings a dish, for example, lets neighbours who never spoke to each other become friends. Preparation also requires cooperation, since volunteers organise stalls, music and safety, and working together on a common goal strengthens relationships. Shared memories of such events give a community a sense of history and identity that lasts long after the festival is over.

Furthermore, festivals celebrate and preserve local culture, which helps people to appreciate their heritage and to share it with newcomers. They can also bring different generations and groups together, from children to grandparents and from long-term residents to migrants. However, festivals do not automatically strengthen bonds. If prices are high, if the programme reflects only one group or if noise and crowds upset residents, some people may feel excluded or annoyed. Organisers should therefore make events free or cheap, involve people from all parts of the community in planning and consider the needs of neighbours. When these steps are taken, festivals can be one of the simplest and most enjoyable ways to build community spirit.

In conclusion, I agree that community festivals strengthen social bonds, because they bring people together and create shared memories, provided that they are inclusive and well organised.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **street parties to harvest fairs** — từ tiệc đường phố đến hội mùa gặt
- **mark special days together** — cùng kỷ niệm những ngày đặc biệt
- **community festivals strengthen social bonds** — lễ hội cộng đồng củng cố gắn kết xã hội
- **bring neighbours together** — gắn kết hàng xóm
- **create shared memories** — tạo ký ức chung
- **cook, perform and celebrate side by side** — nấu ăn, biểu diễn và ăn mừng cạnh nhau
- **builds trust, pride in the place** — xây lòng tin, tự hào về nơi mình sống
- **a sense of belonging** — cảm giác thuộc về
- **brings a dish** — mang theo một món ăn
- **never spoke to each other** — chưa bao giờ nói chuyện với nhau
- **organise stalls, music and safety** — tổ chức gian hàng, âm nhạc và an ninh
- **a common goal** — một mục tiêu chung
- **a sense of history and identity** — cảm giác về lịch sử và bản sắc
- **preserve local culture** — gìn giữ văn hoá địa phương
- **appreciate their heritage** — trân trọng di sản của họ
- **long-term residents to migrants** — từ cư dân lâu năm đến người nhập cư
- **upset residents** — làm cư dân khó chịu
- **feel excluded or annoyed** — cảm thấy bị loại trừ hoặc khó chịu
- **free or cheap** — miễn phí hoặc rẻ
- **people from all parts of the community** — người từ mọi phần của cộng đồng
- **community spirit** — tinh thần cộng đồng
- **bring people together** — gắn kết mọi người

#408 Agree / Disagree · 295 từ · AI 8.0

To what extent do you agree or disagree that parents should limit screen time for children?

Children today spend hours every day looking at televisions, tablets, phones and games consoles, and many people say that parents should limit screen time. I agree with this view, since too much screen use harms sleep, activity and development, although the aim should be balance, not total prohibition.

To begin with, parents should set sensible limits on screen time because too much screen use reduces sleep, exercise and face-to-face play. A family that keeps phones out of bedrooms at night, for example, finds that children sleep better and arrive at school more alert. Research has linked long hours of screen use with poor sleep, lower concentration, obesity and, in some cases, anxiety and low mood. Young children, whose brains are developing rapidly, need real-world play, conversation and movement far more than passive viewing. Without limits, attractive games and videos designed to hold attention can crowd out homework, reading and friendships.

Furthermore, limits give children a chance to learn self-control and to develop other interests. Children seldom judge for themselves when they have had enough, so parents have to provide the structure until they can do so. However, limits should be reasonable and flexible. Screens can be used for learning, creativity and keeping in touch, and not all screen time is equal; a video call with a grandparent or an educational programme differs from endless scrolling. Rules work best when they are explained, agreed with children and followed by the parents themselves, for example by having screen-free meals. Over time, children can be given more responsibility to manage their own use as they mature.

In conclusion, I agree that parents should limit screen time for children, because excessive use harms health and development, but the limits should be balanced and combined with good example and explanation.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **televisions, tablets, phones and games consoles** — ti vi, máy tính bảng, điện thoại và máy chơi game
- **limit screen time** — giới hạn thời gian màn hình
- **too much screen use** — dùng màn hình quá nhiều
- **harms sleep, activity and development** — hại giấc ngủ, vận động và sự phát triển
- **balance, not total prohibition** — cân bằng chứ không cấm hoàn toàn
- **sensible limits** — giới hạn hợp lý
- **face-to-face play** — chơi trực tiếp
- **keeps phones out of bedrooms at night** — để điện thoại ngoài phòng ngủ ban đêm
- **arrive at school more alert** — đến trường tỉnh táo hơn
- **long hours of screen use** — nhiều giờ dùng màn hình
- **poor sleep, lower concentration, obesity** — ngủ kém, tập trung thấp, béo phì
- **anxiety and low mood** — lo âu và tâm trạng thấp
- **passive viewing** — xem thụ động
- **designed to hold attention** — được thiết kế để giữ sự chú ý
- **crowd out homework, reading and friendships** — lấn át bài tập, đọc sách và tình bạn
- **learn self-control** — học tự chủ
- **develop other interests** — phát triển sở thích khác
- **not all screen time is equal** — không phải mọi thời gian dùng màn hình đều như nhau
- **screen-free meals** — bữa ăn không màn hình
- **manage their own use** — tự quản việc sử dụng của mình

Causes / Solutions

#89 Causes / Solutions · 297 từ · AI 7.0

What are the causes of low birth rates in some countries? What solutions can be proposed?

In many developed countries, the average woman now has fewer than two children, and some governments worry about shrinking populations. This essay will analyse the principal causes of low birth rates and propose realistic solutions.

Low birth rates reflect the high cost of raising children and the difficulty of combining work and family. Housing, childcare and education are expensive, women increasingly pursue careers and marry later, and long working hours and insecure jobs make couples delay or limit families. A couple who postpone parenthood until they can afford a larger flat, for example, may find that they have only one child. In addition, changes in attitudes, such as greater emphasis on personal freedom and careers, and access to contraception, mean that parenthood is a choice made later and less often than in the past. Concern about the future, including climate change and economic uncertainty, also discourages some couples. As a result, many people end up with fewer children than they would like.

To address this issue, governments should make it easier for couples to have the children they want. Affordable childcare, housing support, parental leave for both parents, flexible working and financial help reduce the costs and career penalties of having a child. In addition, employers can be encouraged to offer part-time options and to avoid penalising workers who take leave. Countries that have introduced generous and well-designed family policies, such as in parts of northern Europe, have generally seen higher birth rates than those that have not. Immigration can also help to maintain the workforce, although it is not a complete solution on its own.

In conclusion, low birth rates stem mainly from the costs of raising children and the difficulty of balancing work and family, but practical support for parents offers a realistic way forward.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **fewer than two children** — dưới hai con
- **shrinking populations** — dân số thu hẹp
- **analyse the principal causes** — phân tích các nguyên nhân chính
- **low birth rates** — tỷ lệ sinh thấp
- **the high cost of raising children** — chi phí nuôi con cao
- **combining work and family** — kết hợp công việc và gia đình
- **Housing, childcare and education are expensive** — nhà ở, chăm sóc trẻ và giáo dục đắt đỏ
- **pursue careers and marry later** — theo đuổi sự nghiệp và kết hôn muộn
- **long working hours and insecure jobs** — giờ làm dài và việc làm bấp bênh
- **delay or limit families** — trì hoãn hoặc hạn chế việc có con
- **postpone parenthood** — hoãn việc làm cha mẹ
- **a larger flat** — căn hộ lớn hơn
- **personal freedom and careers** — tự do cá nhân và sự nghiệp
- **access to contraception** — tiếp cận biện pháp tránh thai
- **economic uncertainty** — bất ổn kinh tế
- **fewer children than they would like** — ít con hơn mong muốn
- **have the children they want** — có số con như mong muốn
- **Affordable childcare, housing support** — chăm sóc trẻ giá phải chăng, hỗ trợ nhà ở
- **parental leave for both parents** — nghỉ chăm con cho cả hai bậc cha mẹ
- **flexible working** — làm việc linh hoạt
- **penalising workers who take leave** — phạt người lao động nghỉ phép
- **maintain the workforce** — duy trì lực lượng lao động

#222 Causes / Solutions · 284 từ · AI 8.0

How can governments support elderly people living alone? Suggest practical measures.

In many countries, a growing number of older people live alone, and some of them are isolated, ill or afraid. This essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take, focusing on care and safety in the home and on reducing loneliness and supporting independence.

To begin with, governments should help older people to stay safe and healthy at home. Home-care services, regular health visits, suitable housing and alarm systems reduce risks and allow people to live independently for longer. An eighty-year-old who falls at home and cannot reach the telephone, for example, may lie for hours unless an alarm system calls for help. Nurses who visit regularly can detect illness early, and help with shopping, meals and cleaning keeps people in their own homes instead of moving into expensive residential care. Grants for adapting homes, such as fitting handrails or a walk-in shower, prevent accidents. This costs less than hospital or care-home places and respects older people's wishes.

In addition, authorities should reduce loneliness and encourage social contact. Community centres, lunch clubs, befriending schemes in which volunteers visit or phone isolated people, and cheap public transport help older people to stay connected. Training in basic digital skills allows them to speak to their families by video and to access services online. Equally important, a regular check by neighbours, local officials or postal workers can identify those who are in difficulty. Governments should also ensure adequate pensions, since poverty makes isolation worse. These measures help older people to keep their dignity and reduce the pressure on health services and relatives.

In conclusion, providing safe, supported living at home and encouraging social contact offer the most realistic way of helping elderly people who live alone.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a growing number of older people live alone** — ngày càng nhiều người cao tuổi sống một mình
- **isolated, ill or afraid** — bị cô lập, ốm hoặc sợ hãi
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **safe and healthy at home** — an toàn và khoẻ mạnh tại nhà
- **Home-care services, regular health visits** — dịch vụ chăm sóc tại nhà, thăm khám sức khoẻ định kỳ
- **suitable housing and alarm systems** — nhà ở phù hợp và hệ thống báo động
- **live independently for longer** — sống độc lập lâu hơn
- **falls at home and cannot reach the telephone** — ngã ở nhà và không với tới điện thoại
- **lie for hours** — nằm hàng giờ
- **detect illness early** — phát hiện bệnh sớm
- **residential care** — chăm sóc nội trú
- **fitting handrails or a walk-in shower** — lắp tay vịn hoặc vòi tắm không bậc
- **respects older people's wishes** — tôn trọng mong muốn của người cao tuổi
- **reduce loneliness** — giảm cô đơn
- **lunch clubs, befriending schemes** — câu lạc bộ ăn trưa, chương trình kết bạn
- **isolated people** — người bị cô lập
- **public transport** — giao thông công cộng
- **basic digital skills** — kỹ năng số cơ bản
- **a regular check by neighbours** — kiểm tra thường xuyên của hàng xóm
- **adequate pensions** — lương hưu đủ sống
- **keep their dignity** — giữ phẩm giá
- **pressure on health services and relatives** — áp lực lên dịch vụ y tế và người thân

#424 Causes / Solutions · 287 từ · AI 8.0

How can governments improve access to affordable childcare? Suggest practical measures.

For many families, the cost of childcare is as high as a second mortgage, and shortages of places force some parents to stop working. This essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take, focusing on reducing the cost of childcare and on increasing the supply and quality of places.

To begin with, governments should make childcare more affordable. Subsidies paid directly to providers or to parents, tax credits and free hours of early education for all children reduce costs and give families a real choice. A single parent who receives a subsidy for a registered childminder, for example, can take a full-time job instead of relying on benefits. Support should be targeted at those with the lowest incomes, but a basic entitlement for all can avoid stigma and encourage wide participation. Employers can also be encouraged, through tax incentives, to offer workplace nurseries or childcare vouchers.

In addition, authorities should increase supply and ensure quality. Funding for new nurseries in areas where places are short, training and fair pay for staff, and clear quality standards with regular inspections give parents confidence. Low pay leads to high staff turnover, which harms children, so better wages are an investment in quality. Flexible provision, such as evening or weekend care for shift workers, and support for community-based schemes and registered childminders help families whose working hours do not fit standard times. Equally important, flexible working rules for employers allow parents to share care between them. These measures cost money, but they cost less than the benefits and lost tax revenue that result when parents cannot work.

In conclusion, reducing costs and expanding the supply and quality of places offer the most realistic way of improving access to affordable childcare.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **the cost of childcare** — chi phí chăm sóc trẻ
- **a second mortgage** — khoản thế chấp thứ hai
- **shortages of places** — thiếu chỗ
- **stop working** — ngừng làm việc
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **reducing the cost of childcare** — giảm chi phí chăm sóc trẻ
- **increasing the supply and quality of places** — tăng số lượng và chất lượng các chỗ
- **Subsidies paid directly to providers or to parents** — trợ cấp trả trực tiếp cho nhà cung cấp hoặc cha mẹ
- **tax credits** — tín dụng thuế
- **free hours of early education** — giờ giáo dục sớm miễn phí
- **a real choice** — lựa chọn thực sự
- **a registered childminder** — người trông trẻ được đăng ký
- **relying on benefits** — dựa vào trợ cấp
- **the lowest incomes** — thu nhập thấp nhất
- **participation** — sự tham gia
- **workplace nurseries or childcare vouchers** — nhà trẻ nơi làm việc hoặc phiếu chăm sóc trẻ
- **clear quality standards with regular inspections** — chuẩn chất lượng rõ ràng kèm thanh tra định kỳ
- **high staff turnover** — nhân viên nghỉ việc nhiều
- **evening or weekend care for shift workers** — chăm sóc buổi tối hoặc cuối tuần cho người làm ca
- **flexible working rules** — quy định làm việc linh hoạt
- **share care** — chia sẻ việc chăm sóc
- **lost tax revenue** — nguồn thu thuế bị mất
- **affordable childcare** — chăm sóc trẻ giá phải chăng

Advantages / Disadvantages

#97 Advantages / Disadvantages · 312 từ · AI 8.0

What are the benefits for a country that focuses on early childhood care? Use examples.

The first few years of life shape a child's health, learning and behaviour for decades, and many governments now invest in nurseries and early education. This essay will outline two principal benefits for a country that focuses on early childhood care: better outcomes for children and wider gains for families and the economy.

First and foremost, good care in the early years gives children a lasting advantage. The brain develops fastest before the age of five, and quality nurseries build language, social skills and curiosity. A child who spends mornings in a good nursery, for example, enters school already able to listen, share and speak in sentences. Children from disadvantaged homes benefit most, since they may have fewer books and less conversation at home, so early care narrows the gap before formal schooling starts. As a result, children arrive at school ready to learn, and they are less likely to need extra support or to drop out later. Trained staff can also notice health or developmental problems early.

In addition, early childhood care brings wider benefits to families and the economy. When affordable care is available, parents, especially mothers, can return to work, which raises household income and tax revenue and supports gender equality. Research in several countries has found that every unit of money spent on high-quality early education returns several times as much through better school results, higher earnings and lower costs for health, welfare and crime. Although high-quality care requires investment in staff training and buildings, and poor-quality care can do little good, the long-term returns are large. Countries such as Denmark and Sweden, where early care is widely available and highly regarded, show how a society can benefit.

To sum up, early childhood care brings clear benefits to a country, above all better outcomes for children and wider economic gains. For these reasons, it deserves sustained public support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **shape a child's health, learning and behaviour** — định hình sức khoẻ, học tập và hành vi của trẻ
- **nurseries and early education** — nhà trẻ và giáo dục sớm
- **early childhood care** — chăm sóc trẻ nhỏ
- **better outcomes for children** — kết quả tốt hơn cho trẻ
- **wider gains for families and the economy** — lợi ích rộng hơn cho gia đình và kinh tế
- **a lasting advantage** — lợi thế lâu dài
- **The brain develops fastest before the age of five** — não phát triển nhanh nhất trước năm tuổi
- **build language, social skills and curiosity** — xây dựng ngôn ngữ, kỹ năng xã hội và sự tò mò
- **listen, share and speak in sentences** — lắng nghe, chia sẻ và nói thành câu
- **disadvantaged homes** — gia đình khó khăn
- **narrows the gap before formal schooling starts** — thu hẹp khoảng cách trước khi vào học chính thức
- **ready to learn** — sẵn sàng học
- **drop out later** — bỏ học về sau
- **health or developmental problems** — vấn đề sức khoẻ hoặc phát triển
- **return to work** — trở lại làm việc
- **raises household income and tax revenue** — tăng thu nhập hộ gia đình và nguồn thu thuế
- **supports gender equality** — hỗ trợ bình đẳng giới
- **returns several times as much** — hoàn lại nhiều lần
- **higher earnings and lower costs** — thu nhập cao hơn và chi phí thấp hơn
- **staff training and buildings** — đào tạo nhân viên và cơ sở vật chất
- **long-term returns** — lợi nhuận dài hạn
- **widely available** — sẵn có rộng rãi
- **clear benefits** — lợi ích rõ ràng
- **economic gains** — lợi ích kinh tế
- **sustained public support** — sự hỗ trợ công lâu dài

#381 Advantages / Disadvantages · 273 từ · AI 7.5

Do the advantages of state-funded childcare outweigh the cost? Give reasons and examples.

In several countries, the state pays for much of the cost of nurseries and after-school care, while in others parents pay most of the cost themselves. This essay will discuss the advantages and the cost of state-funded childcare before explaining whether the advantages outweigh the cost.

On the positive side, state-funded childcare pays for itself through higher employment and better child development. Parents, especially mothers, can work and pay taxes, children from poorer homes gain early education, and the economy benefits from a more skilled workforce. A mother who returns to work because nursery places are affordable, for example, pays taxes instead of receiving benefits. Good care also helps children to arrive at school ready to learn, which reduces later spending on remedial help, and it promotes gender equality by allowing women to pursue careers. Countries such as Denmark and Sweden, which fund early care generously, have high levels of female employment and strong child wellbeing.

On the negative side, state-funded childcare is expensive, and the cost must be met through taxes, which may fall on people without children. Poorly designed systems may produce low-quality care, long waiting lists or poor pay for staff, and critics argue that some parents would prefer to care for children at home or to receive cash instead. Nevertheless, these concerns can be addressed. Quality standards, trained and fairly paid staff and a choice between types of care make the system effective, and the returns in tax revenue and children's future earnings often exceed the original cost.

In conclusion, the advantages of state-funded childcare outweigh the cost, provided that the system is well designed and maintains high standards.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **nurseries and after-school care** — nhà trẻ và chăm sóc sau giờ học
- **state-funded childcare** — chăm sóc trẻ do nhà nước tài trợ
- **outweigh the cost** — lớn hơn chi phí
- **pays for itself** — tự hoàn vốn
- **higher employment and better child development** — việc làm cao hơn và phát triển trẻ tốt hơn
- **pay taxes** — đóng thuế
- **children from poorer homes gain early education** — trẻ nhà nghèo được giáo dục sớm
- **a more skilled workforce** — lực lượng lao động có kỹ năng hơn
- **nursery places are affordable** — chỗ nhà trẻ giá phải chăng
- **instead of receiving benefits** — thay vì nhận trợ cấp
- **ready to learn** — sẵn sàng học
- **remedial help** — hỗ trợ học bù
- **gender equality** — bình đẳng giới
- **pursue careers** — theo đuổi sự nghiệp
- **high levels of female employment** — tỷ lệ việc làm của phụ nữ cao
- **strong child wellbeing** — phúc lợi trẻ em tốt
- **met through taxes** — được trang trải qua thuế
- **low-quality care, long waiting lists** — chăm sóc chất lượng thấp, danh sách chờ dài
- **poor pay for staff** — lương nhân viên thấp
- **care for children** — chăm sóc con cái
- **Quality standards, trained and fairly paid staff** — chuẩn chất lượng, nhân viên được đào tạo và trả lương công bằng
- **exceed the original cost** — vượt chi phí ban đầu

#479 Advantages / Disadvantages · 289 từ · AI 7.5

What are the benefits for a country that focuses on family-friendly policies? Use examples.

Governments are increasingly interested in paid leave, flexible working hours, childcare and housing support for families, and these are often called family-friendly policies. This essay will outline two principal benefits for a country that focuses on such policies: better outcomes for children and parents, and gains for the economy and society.

First and foremost, family-friendly policies benefit children and parents. Paid leave, flexible hours and childcare help couples to have the children they want, keep skilled workers in employment and give children a better start. An employee who can start early and leave in time to collect her child from school, for example, stays in her job instead of resigning, and she is less stressed at home. Parents who have time and money to spend with young children can support their development, which improves health and learning. In countries with generous policies, such as Sweden, poverty among children is low and parents report a better balance between work and family life.

In addition, family-friendly policies bring wider economic and social gains. Women's employment rises when childcare is available, which increases tax revenue and household incomes, and employers keep experienced staff instead of paying to recruit and train replacements. Birth rates may be higher where families receive support, which helps to maintain the workforce as populations age. Gender equality also improves, since both parents can share work and care. Although such policies cost money, studies suggest that they pay for themselves over time through higher employment and better child outcomes. Society also benefits, since stronger families produce healthier, more confident citizens.

To sum up, family-friendly policies bring clear benefits to a country, above all better outcomes for children and a stronger economy. For these reasons, they deserve sustained public support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **paid leave, flexible working hours, childcare and housing support** — nghỉ có lương, giờ làm linh hoạt, chăm sóc trẻ và hỗ trợ nhà ở
- **family-friendly policies** — chính sách thân thiện với gia đình
- **better outcomes for children and parents** — kết quả tốt hơn cho trẻ và cha mẹ
- **gains for the economy and society** — lợi ích cho kinh tế và xã hội
- **have the children they want** — có số con như mong muốn
- **keep skilled workers in employment** — giữ lao động có kỹ năng trong việc làm
- **give children a better start** — cho trẻ khởi đầu tốt hơn
- **start early and leave in time** — bắt đầu sớm và rời đi đúng giờ
- **collect her child from school** — đón con từ trường
- **stays in her job instead of resigning** — ở lại công việc thay vì nghỉ
- **less stressed at home** — ít căng thẳng ở nhà
- **support their development** — hỗ trợ sự phát triển của chúng
- **poverty among children is low** — tỷ lệ nghèo ở trẻ em thấp
- **a better balance between work and family life** — cân bằng tốt hơn giữa công việc và đời sống gia đình
- **Women's employment rises** — việc làm của phụ nữ tăng
- **increases tax revenue and household incomes** — tăng nguồn thu thuế và thu nhập hộ gia đình
- **recruit and train replacements** — tuyển dụng và đào tạo người thay thế
- **maintain the workforce as populations age** — duy trì lực lượng lao động khi dân số già
- **gender equality** — bình đẳng giới
- **share work and care** — chia sẻ công việc và việc chăm sóc
- **pay for themselves over time** — tự hoàn vốn theo thời gian
- **clear benefits** — lợi ích rõ ràng

- **better outcomes for children** — kết quả tốt hơn cho trẻ
- **a stronger economy** — nền kinh tế mạnh hơn
- **sustained public support** — sự hỗ trợ công lâu dài